Tasting Time



IN THE RAREFIED world of collectible whiskies, age is a measure of prestige. In India, it is a triumph over nature. Amrut Expedition, the country's oldest single malt at 15 years, is a testament to its maker's mastery over wood, climate and time.

The genius lies in its casking. India's tropical climate extracts a punishing price: annual evaporation losses, poetically called the angel's share, approaching 10% against Scotland's 2%. Fifteen years of maturation is therefore an audacious undertaking.

Amrut's masterstroke was its passage through two distinct woods. Eight years in a European sherry cask bestowed richness and opulence; seven more in an American ex-bourbon cask refined its complexity. The resulting 62.8% ABV expression unfolds in